Decision-OS V10 Note: Survival-Bounded Planning

Why Optimization Conflicts with Survival

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Abstract

Optimization assumes that an objective can remain fixed long enough to be reached. Survival denies this assumption. Under resource, time, and uncertainty constraints, the problem is not only how to move efficiently toward a goal, but whether the current goal-length remains survivable.

This note introduces **Survival-Bounded Planning** as a minimal extension of the Decision-OS lineage. V9 fixed evaluation through As-of, Seat, and Release: decisions must be reviewed from the time they were made, responsibility must remain seated, and release must require sustained passing under impact. V10 moves one layer forward: when survival constraints tighten, the objective itself must be rescaled rather than preserved unchanged.

The core claim is simple: **planning is not preserving a goal, but recalculating a survivable trajectory toward aspiration.** The framework distinguishes recoverable deviation from non-recoverable deviation. If returnability remains, the system should return. If returnability is lost, the objective must be rescaled. This preserves aspiration without forcing collapse through fixed-goal optimization.

1. Introduction

Optimization is often treated as a virtue: define a goal, allocate resources, reduce error, and move toward completion. This works when the environment is stable, the target is reachable, and the cost of continuation does not threaten the agent or system itself.

However, long-horizon projects rarely satisfy these conditions. Resources decay. Time windows close. Uncertainty changes the path. A plan that was rational at one scale may become destructive at another scale.

In this setting, the central failure is not lack of effort. The failure is **goal-length rigidity**: continuing to optimize toward a fixed target after the path has exceeded the survivable range.

Decision-OS V9 addressed a related but different problem. V9 fixed the evaluation layer: decisions must be reviewed through an As-of Pack, responsibility must remain assigned to a Seat, and public release must be treated as an impact-weighted continuous pass rather than one-shot correctness. V10 does not replace this. It asks what happens after evaluation is fixed, when the plan itself can no longer survive at its original length.

The answer is not to abandon aspiration. The answer is to change the scale of the path.

2. Question

Why do optimization and survival conflict?

Optimization fixes a target and tries to reduce deviation from that target. Survival must preserve the capacity to continue under changing constraints.

The conflict appears when maintaining the original target consumes the very resources required for future action. At that point, optimization can become anti-survival: it maximizes progress toward a goal while minimizing the probability that the agent remains able to act.

This produces the central question of V10:

> When should a plan stop preserving the original goal and instead rescale the trajectory so that aspiration remains reachable?

3. Core Claim

Planning is not preserving a goal, but recalculating a survivable trajectory toward aspiration.

In this note, “dream” refers to the human-side aspiration that gives a project its meaning. A target is a concrete expression of that aspiration at a given time; a plan is the procedure selected to reach it; and a trajectory is the actual path taken under resource, time, and uncertainty constraints. V10 preserves the dream by allowing targets, plans, and trajectories to be rescaled.

A goal is a fixed expression of aspiration at a given time, under a given resource state. Aspiration is the longer-horizon direction that may survive even when the original goal-length cannot.

Therefore, a plan must not be judged only by whether it preserves the original goal. It must also be judged by whether it preserves the agent’s ability to continue moving toward the underlying aspiration.

In short:

> A goal may shrink without aspiration dying.

This distinction prevents two common errors:

1. Treating rescaling as failure.
2. Treating persistence as virtue even when it destroys future capacity.

4. Minimal Structure

Survival-Bounded Planning requires only five terms:

4.1 Aspire

Aspire is the long-horizon direction. It is not a short-term target and not a performance metric. In the Decision-OS lineage, Aspire has already been positioned as a direction-over-time term: without direction, recursion can collapse into an empty coherence loop.

In V10, Aspire is the part that must be preserved.

4.2 Length

Length is the current scale of the plan: the distance, cost, time, and complexity required to reach the expressed goal.

A plan can fail not because Aspire is wrong, but because the current Length exceeds the survivable range.

4.3 Recoverability

Recoverability is the ability to return to a viable path without changing the objective scale.

If deviation is still recoverable, the correct action is correction.

If deviation is no longer recoverable, correction becomes self-deception.

4.4 Drift

Drift is the accumulated deviation between the current trajectory and the survivable path.

Drift is not automatically bad. Some drift is exploration. But drift becomes dangerous when it consumes optionality, reduces branching, or destroys reversibility.

This connects to V8's trajectory view: V8 moved evaluation from pointwise outputs to Time-Tube trajectories, with direction, curvature, branching, drift, and reversibility as control-relevant signals.

4.5 Rescale

Rescale is the act of changing the goal-length while preserving Aspire.

Rescale is not surrender. It is survival-preserving recalculation.

5. Key Distinction: Recoverable vs. Non-Recoverable

The central operational distinction is:

> **Recoverable deviation should be returned. Non-recoverable deviation should be rescaled.**

If the system can return to the original path without destroying survivability, it should return.

If return would consume the remaining capacity needed for future action, the system should not force return. It should rescale.

This gives the core intervention rule:

> **Intervention begins at the loss of returnability.**

The loss of returnability is stronger than ordinary delay, discomfort, or temporary failure. It means that the original path can no longer be restored without imposing unacceptable cost on future capacity.

At that point, optimization must stop defending the old scale.

6. Link to V9

V9 fixes evaluation. V10 adjusts the objective.

V9's contribution was to prevent hindsight overwrite, responsibility laundering, and unsafe public release by fixing As-of, Seat, and Release. Its protocol binds explanation to the As-of Pack and sends improvement into a forward-only delta lane.

V10 inherits that structure. It does not allow arbitrary rewriting of the past. The original plan remains evaluated under its As-of constraints.

But V10 adds a forward planning rule:

> Once survival constraints make return non-recoverable, the next valid update is not "try harder," but "rescale the objective while preserving Aspire."

Thus V9 protects the past from hindsight collapse. V10 protects the future from fixed-goal collapse.

7. Implications

7.1 Dreams are not denied

Survival-Bounded Planning does not say that long goals are irrational. It says that long goals must remain compatible with survival.

The framework protects aspiration by refusing to confuse it with a single historical goal-length.

7.2 Distance can change

A plan may remain faithful to the same Aspire while changing its distance, pace, or intermediate form.

The question is not "Did the original goal remain unchanged?"

The question is "Did the trajectory preserve the possibility of continuation?"

7.3 Regret replaces outcome worship

A fixed-goal optimizer asks whether the target was reached.

A survival-bounded planner asks whether the decision preserved future capacity under the information and constraints available at the time.

This preserves the Decision-OS emphasis on As-of reasoning: the goal is not to pretend that every outcome was predictable, but to ensure that the reasoning was non-regretful under the available constraints.

8. Falsifier

The framework is invalid if the following condition consistently holds:

> **If a fixed goal consistently outperforms survival-adjusted planning under resource constraints, this framework is invalid.**

In Japanese:

> **資源制約下でも固定目標の方が常に優れているなら、この理論は成立しない。**

This falsifier matters because V10 must not become a motivational essay. It is a planning claim. If fixed-goal persistence produces better survival, better long-term aspiration retention, and lower regret under comparable constraints, then Survival-Bounded Planning loses its reason to exist.

9. Scope Boundary

This note is intentionally narrow.

It does not define a product.

It does not introduce a companion system.

It does not formalize MMAR or multi-model governance.

It does not quantify Talent, EWH, or production capacity.

It does not introduce a new AGI definition.

Those topics may connect to later work, but they are outside V10's minimal claim.

V10 only defines the survival layer between fixed evaluation and future planning:

> When the original goal-length is no longer survivable, preserve Aspire by rescaling the trajectory.

10. Conclusion

Optimization and survival conflict when the fixed goal begins to consume the capacity required to continue.

Decision-OS V10 resolves this conflict by separating Aspire from goal-length. Aspire is preserved; Length is allowed to change. Recoverable deviation is corrected. Non-recoverable deviation is rescaled.

The resulting principle is:

> Planning is not preserving a goal, but recalculating a survivable trajectory toward aspiration.

Or, in one line:

> **V10 is how to survive without breaking the dream: rescale the trajectory, not the aspiration.**